Community Involvement Opportunities

RetailzPOS / Vitreous Alliance · Patel Processing — Henry County, GA & Metro Atlanta · October 22, 2026

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About this report

This is the first of a recurring report, delivered every 4 days, surfacing real community events, sponsorships, and involvement opportunities — originally scoped to Henry County, GA, now expanded to cover the broader metro Atlanta area as well — where RetailzPOS and Vitreous Alliance / Patel Processing could get involved: as a sponsor, vendor/booth presence, networking participant, or community-giving partner.

Honesty note on the data: Henry County is a smaller market, so several local categories (town-square festival exact 2026/2027 dates, Rotary/Lions sponsorship tiers, a dedicated Henry County small-business expo) turned up genuinely thin or unconfirmed. The metro Atlanta sections below are richer but also more seasonally uneven — several of the area's biggest annual galas, golf tournaments, and fintech conferences already ran earlier in 2026 and are noted here as 2027 planning items

rather than live opportunities. Where a date or detail couldn't be verified, it's flagged below rather than guessed at — several leads need a direct phone call or a check of the organizer's own site to confirm before committing.

Time-sensitive flag: the Cristo Rey Atlanta golf tournament (Charity & Sponsorship, Metro Atlanta section) is Monday, October 26 — only 4 days out. If there's any interest, that decision needs to happen this week.

PART 1 — Henry County, GA

Chamber of Commerce / Networking

Henry County Chamber of Commerce — ongoing networking programs. Hosts 20+ events/year, including a monthly "Chamber Connections" meeting and "Business Booster" luncheons, typically the third Thursday of the month. Get involved: become a Chamber member, attend luncheons, submit event flyers to the community bulletin board (reviewed within 48 hrs). Source: henrycounty.com/business-networking. Fit: direct, recurring access to local business owners — the Chamber's own membership is largely small/independent retailers, RetailzPOS's core customer base.

59th Annual Installation & Leadership Awards Gala (precedent for a 2027 edition). Henry County Chamber's flagship annual gala; the 2026 edition ran Feb 6, 2026 at Merle Manders Conference Center. No 2027 date posted yet, but worth planning a sponsorship/table around February 2027. Source: business.henrycounty.com — 59th Annual Gala. Fit: visibility with the Chamber's full business membership in one room; a sponsor table is a direct brand-awareness play.

Henry County Chamber Golf Classic. Annual fundraiser, historically held late Sept/early Oct at Heron Bay Golf & Country Club or Georgia National Golf Club; the 24th annual ran Sept 30, 2024 with sponsorships available. No confirmed 2026 date found — worth a direct call to the Chamber (lrobinson@henrycounty.com / 770-957-5786) to confirm this year's date/sponsorship tiers. Fit: classic local B2B sponsorship format, puts the logo in front of area business owners and decision-makers.

Business / Retail-Specific Events

Georgia Association of Convenience Stores (GACS) — Southern Convenience Store and Petroleum Show. A 2026 edition is listed for **October 22, 2026** in Columbus, GA — the single best-fit event found: a trade show specifically for convenience-store/petroleum retailers, GACS's flagship event. This listing is third-party and may already have passed by the time this lands — confirm directly at gacs.com/events, and watch for a 2027 date. Source: Canton Fair listing. Fit: this is about as direct as it gets — the exact audience RetailzPOS sells to, in one room, at a booth-friendly trade show.

GACS Annual Convention. A separate, larger GACS event; one third-party aggregator lists May 31–June 3, 2026 on Amelia Island, FL (500–1,000 attendees), but this conflicts with GACS's historical August timing — treat as unconfirmed and verify directly with GACS. Fit: same as above, statewide reach beyond just metro Atlanta.

Henry County Chamber "Building Economic Bridges" discussion series. A 4-part Chamber + United Way of Greater Atlanta series aimed at banks, lenders, and community stakeholders around small-business support; session 1 ran April 28, 2026 at the Chamber's McDonough office. Contact: Jennifer Young, (678) 640-9741. Fit: positions Patel Processing specifically as a fintech partner to the small-business lending/support conversation, not just a vendor.

No dedicated Henry County small-business expo was found for 2026 — this category is genuinely thin locally; the GACS trade show above is the strongest substitute.

Festivals & Community Events

Geranium Festival (McDonough). The city's flagship annual festival, downtown on the McDonough Square; 2026 will be the 49th annual, historically held in May. No exact 2026 date confirmed yet — check geraniumfestival.com directly. Vendor/sponsor booths are part of the festival format. Fit: largest single foot-traffic event in the county seat; a vendor booth puts RetailzPOS/Moolah Points in front of the general public and local shop owners who walk the square.

City of McDonough Christmas Parade & Tree Lighting. Annual tradition (36+ years running), historically late November on the McDonough Square (2024 ran Nov 30, lighting at 5pm, parade at 6pm). No 2026 date confirmed yet — check City of McDonough / Main Street McDonough. **Timing note: this is likely the single most actionable near-term opportunity in this report, given it falls in the next ~5**

weeks. Fit: high-visibility community goodwill event; sponsoring a float or a vendor table reaches local families and merchants alike.

BridgeFest (Stockbridge). City of Stockbridge's annual arts & crafts festival, historically late September (2025 ran Sept 27). No 2026 date confirmed. Source: business.henrycounty.com — BridgeFest listing. Fit: second-largest city in the county, similar vendor-booth opportunity — worth tracking for its 2027 date.

Stockbridge Food Truck Tasty Tuesdays. Recurring city-run series at Clark Park; confirmed 2026 dates ran June 9–23 and July 14–28. Lower-key but repeatable local visibility if a vendor/info-table presence is allowed — worth confirming with the city for next summer. Fit: lighter-touch, repeatable local presence.

Locust Grove and Hampton turned up no confirmed events in this search — genuinely thin for those two towns specifically; worth checking each city's own site directly.

Charity & Sponsorship Opportunities

Drive for Bright Futures Golf Tournament (Henry County Public Schools Foundation). Benefits Henry County Schools athletics and resources. Sponsorship tiers: Title $10,000 (logo placement, speaking slot, banner, 2 foursomes), Platinum $5,000, Gold $2,500, Silver $1,500, Hole sponsorship $250. Contact: maria.lumpkin@henry.k12.ga.us. One listing marked this as a past event — confirm current status before committing. Fit: strong community-goodwill play tied to local schools, affordable entry point at the $250–$1,500 tiers.

Family Bridge Trunk-A-Treat & Food Drive. Henry County Chamber members invited to sponsor, run a decorated vendor vehicle, or donate food/candy. Was set for Saturday, October 24, 2026 — **this has likely already passed or is happening in the next 2 days by the time this lands; flag for the 2027 cycle instead.** Contact: (770) 473-4600.

Connecting Henry — Community Cares Toy Shop. Recurring annual holiday toy drive/shop for local families in need; has sought business sponsors/donors in past years. Contact: 770-288-6230. No 2026-specific sponsorship details confirmed yet — worth a direct call given the holiday timing fits the next 1-3 months. Fit: classic low-cost, high-goodwill holiday-season community giving.

Multicultural / Heritage Events

No Diwali event was found specifically in McDonough, Stockbridge, or elsewhere in Henry County for 2026. The nearest confirmed event is the **Johns Creek Diwali Celebration**, Saturday Nov 7, 2026, 2–7pm — but Johns Creek is roughly 30+ miles north, outside the Henry County/south-metro footprint and a weaker geographic fit. Source: johnscreekga.gov/events/diwali-celebration. Given RetailzPOS's South Asian merchant customer base, it may be worth checking directly with local Indian-American community/temple groups in Henry County (none surfaced in this search) for a smaller, unlisted local gathering rather than relying on the Johns Creek event.

Recurring / lower-priority leads

- **Henry County Farmers Market (UGA Extension)** — weekly Thursday market at Heritage Park, historically June–August, ~$25/season vendor fee (needs reconfirming). Contact: UGA Extension Henry County, 770-288-8421. Seasonal fit only — out of window until next summer.
- **Rotary Club of Henry County** — meets Mondays at noon (venue has shifted between a few local restaurants; confirm current location before attending). Contact: Henrycountyrotaryclub@gmail.com / 404-402-7666. No current sponsorship-tier figures confirmed. Standard civic-networking entry point, worth a direct inquiry call.

Henry County scope note

This pass covered Henry County towns (McDonough, Stockbridge, Hampton, Locust Grove) directly. It did not search Clayton, Fayette, Spalding, Newton, Butts, or Rockdale counties individually beyond general searches that didn't surface county-specific events.

PART 2 — Metro Atlanta

Added at the user's request to broaden this report's geographic scope beyond Henry County. Covers the city of Atlanta and the wider metro area (Fulton, DeKalb, Clayton, Fayette, Cobb, Gwinnett).

Chamber of Commerce / Networking (Metro Atlanta)

TAG (Technology Association of Georgia) Chairs' Gala 2026. Thursday, Nov 19, 2026, 6–11pm at Hotel Phoenix, Atlanta. TAG's premier annual evening event. Get involved: contact sponsorship@tagonline.org for sponsorship/attendance. Source: TAG member calendar. Fit: puts Patel Processing's fintech side in front of Georgia's broader tech/innovation business community — a step up in scale from Henry County networking, and well within the next 1-month window.

Metro Atlanta Chamber — Annual Meeting. No 2026 date confirmed yet; the 2025 edition ran Nov 13, 2025 at the College Football Hall of Fame, so a 2026 edition likely follows a similar November pattern. Source: Metro Atlanta Chamber news/events. Action: check the chamber's site directly — worth a direct inquiry given this is Atlanta's flagship business chamber.

Georgia Hispanic Chamber of Commerce (GHCC). 1,100+ attendees at its signature events. The 2026 flagship gala (Aug 29) and golf tournament (Apr 30) have already passed this cycle; the gala's sponsorship window ran June 15–Aug 7, 2026. Source: GHCC 2026 Signature Events. Action: flag for the 2027 cycle — watch for the sponsorship window opening next summer.

The Atlanta Black Chamber of Commerce turned up no confirmed 2026 events or sponsorship info in this search — genuinely thin, needs a direct site check.

Fintech / Payments Industry Events (Metro Atlanta)

Fintech South (TAG). Already ran Aug 18–19, 2026 at Truist Park, themed "Where Money Moves" (payments, banking, lending, cybersecurity). Already passed, but this is TAG's annual flagship fintech conference and the single best-fit event found for Patel Processing specifically — **mark for 2027 planning now.** Source: TAG — Fintech South recap.

TRANSACT-style payments show, Georgia World Congress Center. Ran Mar 18–20, 2026 (real-time rails, AI risk, partner meetups). Already passed. Source: transactshow.com. Action: watch for a 2027 Atlanta date.

No fall/winter 2026 Atlanta-based payments/acquirer conference was found — this category is seasonally thin right now; both events above are spring/summer-timed, so the next real opportunity is 2027 planning.

Festivals & Holiday Markets (Metro Atlanta, next 1–2 months)

Jingle & Mingle Holiday Market (Junior League of Atlanta). Nov 1, 2026 at JLA headquarters. Vendor categories: gifts/home décor, apparel, jewelry/handmade, specialty foods, art. Contact: holidaymarket@jlatlanta.org. Source: JLA listing. Fit: community-goodwill visibility tied to a respected civic organization — not a direct retail-customer fit, but strong for brand goodwill.

Buckhead Handmade Holiday Market. Dec 5–6, 2026, outdoor arts market (~75 exhibitors). Applications via Eventeny. Source: Eventeny listing. Fit: affluent-neighborhood visibility; more a sponsorship-banner fit than a natural vendor-booth fit for a POS/fintech company.

Atlanta Christkindl Market (Lawrenceville) and **2026 Atlanta Christmas Arts, Crafts & Holiday Vendor Market (Dec 11–13, Cherokee Ave SE)** — both found but listings are tentative/unconfirmed, with no vendor application link surfaced for the latter. Worth a direct follow-up with organizers before committing.

Charity & Sponsorship Opportunities (Metro Atlanta)

Cristo Rey Atlanta Jesuit — Bill Garrett President's Cup Golf Tournament. Monday, **October 26, 2026** — 4 days from this report's delivery. Capital City Club, Brookhaven. Presenting sponsorship ($30K) already sold out; Platinum $20K, Gold $12.5K, Silver $7K, Bronze $3.5K, Hole $1.5K still open. Source: Cristo Rey Atlanta. Fit: time-sensitive — only actionable this week; otherwise mark for 2027.

No other Atlanta-area galas or golf tournaments were found scheduled in the Nov–Dec 2026 window — most major Atlanta nonprofit fundraisers (Wellstar Foundation, Assistance League, AKF, Children's Museum of Atlanta) already ran in their typical Aug–Oct slots. Seasonally thin right now; most leads here are 2027 planning items.

Multicultural / Heritage Events (Metro Atlanta)

Diwali in Atlanta proper — no confirmed 2026 event found. Past precedent exists: Atlanta Mayor Andre Dickens hosted a Diwali celebration at City Hall with the Coalition of Hindus of North America in 2024 (250+ attendees), and Atlantic Station ran a first-time Diwali festival in 2024 (Bollywood screening, henna, vendors) — but neither is confirmed for 2026. Sources: South Asian Herald; Secret Atlanta — Diwali at Atlantic Station. Action: with Diwali on Nov 8, checking Atlanta City Hall's events office and Atlantic Station directly in the next two weeks could catch a 2026 revival before it's announced publicly.

Georgia Indo-American Chamber of Commerce (GIACC). A real, active Atlanta-area South Asian business chamber — co-hosted a 2022 Atlanta Trade Event with the Gwinnett Chamber (Sen. Jon Ossoff and India's Atlanta Consul General attended) and a 2023 small-business import/export networking event, but no 2026 calendar surfaced in search. Source: Global Atlanta GIACC listings. Action: given RetailzPOS's South Asian merchant base, this is the strongest multicultural-fit lead in the whole report — worth direct outreach to GIACC rather than waiting on search results.

Business / Retail-Specific Events (Metro Atlanta)

Small Business Expo — Atlanta. One-day event, Dec 16, 2026, Georgia International Convention Center (organizer estimate: ~10,000 attendees / 100 exhibitors). Organizer: The Show Producers. Source: Tradefest listing. Fit: direct small-business-owner audience at convention-center scale — the strongest Atlanta-proper retail/business expo lead found. Verify directly with the organizer before committing, as this is a third-party aggregator listing.

No NACS-adjacent or additional convenience-store trade events beyond the already-covered GACS show were found specifically in the Atlanta metro area for this window.

Scope note

Henry County pass covered McDonough, Stockbridge, Hampton, Locust Grove directly, without individually searching Clayton, Fayette, Spalding, Newton, Butts, or Rockdale counties. The Metro Atlanta pass covered the city of Atlanta, Buckhead, Brookhaven, and Lawrenceville, but did not specifically search Cobb or Gwinnett county municipal festivals (e.g. Marietta Square, Duluth events) — a future edition can expand there if broader suburban-metro coverage is wanted.

This report recurs every 4 days and now covers both Henry County and metro Atlanta. Each edition will aim to surface newly-dated opportunities and avoid repeating leads already reported, except to flag status changes (a date now confirmed, a deadline approaching, or an opportunity that’s passed).